Election Day Notes 2026
In-Press: November 2nd, 2026

I'm walking the city (Richmond) again for Election Day 2026. The streets were giving nothing in 2024, and that felt like an obvious signal of trouble (after the disastrous right-wing, pro-Israel, pro-war Harris campaign). I'm out here again walking the streets checking on the Capitol and both downtown polling locations. There is a pair of canvassers for both school board candidates (I'm voting DSA-backed McDonnough) at the Richmond Public Library. And a trickle of young voters in and out of the Contemporary Arts building (maybe noticing more than last year). There's nothing else to report in the city, other than it being a warm sunny November around noon (currently 71.2 deg F on my home weather station).

I got VA residency about a week before the deadline to vote, but there's not much that excites me on my Richmond ballot this midterm election. McDonnough for RPS school board is about it. She's a progressive with a strong labor posture, and I hope she wins. There is also a city sales-tax-related vote enabling more school funding, but I'm not so happy about using regressive taxes to pay for things.

As I sit here in the city midday I'm quite confident Democrats will probably win across the board in statewide VA elections and all three amendments will pass. However, the state of Virginia is one that is overwhelmingly compromised by corporate and military-industrial interests (our Democratic governor wouldn't even allow the General Assembly to grant state employees the basic right to collectively bargain). As such, I don't see our national-level politicians as agents of change. Simply our role this time around is to hold the numbers line in the House and Senate if not grab a couple House seats. Real progressive fighters around the country will be the ones to push for real change. I've never felt more potential and more momentum for progressives in this country. I'm really hopeful we can do some big things tonight.